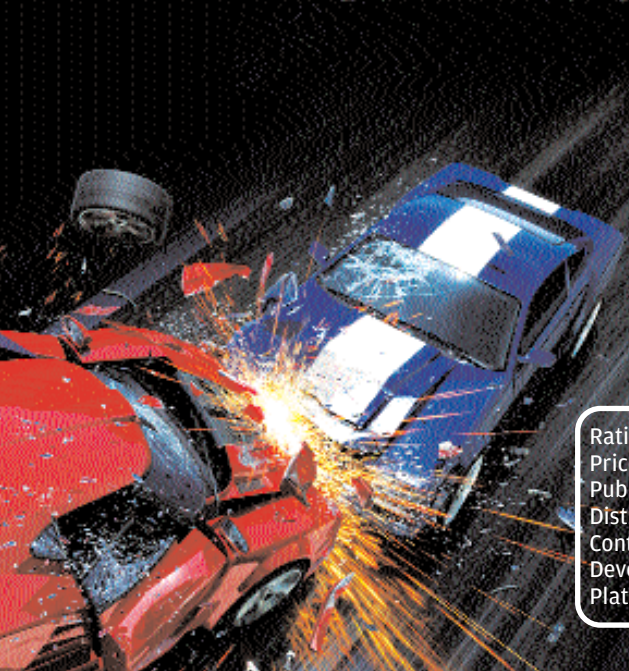


BURNOUT DOMINATOR



Rating: 7/10
Price: Rs 2,499
Publisher: Electronic Arts
Distributor: Milestone Interactive
Contact: sales@milestone-interactive.com
Developer: Criterion
Platform: PS2

Almost Infamous

No game has endeared itself to us the way the *Burnout* series has. Perhaps it's the insane speeds. Or the rewarding feeling (and points) you get when you introduce opponents to the friendly pillar on the corner of the road. There's that sweet taste of revenge as you descend from the skies onto the bonnet of the unsuspecting fool who thought he could get away with taking you down. Ah, good times...

It never occurred to us that Criterion would try and mess with the near-perfection that was *Burnout: Revenge*—they've added

a bunch of new game modes in *Burnout: Dominator*, but one of the best features has now been d i s o w n e d . Traffic checking is gone, so

you can't use the hapless public as pawns in your game of death and destruction anymore. Worse, you have to avoid them! The gloriously destructive Crash mode is gone as well. On the plus side, you can now chain burnouts—drive like a maniac while boosting, and you'll get an instant boost recharge that will let you go even faster. This is all as fun as it sounds, but definitely tougher, what with the going boom every time you hit traffic bit. The overall gameplay hasn't changed enough to warrant comment, other than that we're glad it all feels the same.

Dominator looks amazing, and is a testament to the fact that the old PS2 still has life. For someone new to the franchise, it's an excellent game to have; *Revenge* owners, buy this only if you're bored with the same old locations—it's no quantum leap ahead.

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HEATSEEKER



Simple Joys For Simple People

We wonder if IR Gurus consciously decided to forego any sort of depth when they made *Heatseeker*. This arcade-style flight simulator (we use the term loosely) gives you no story to live through—well, nothing worth mentioning, anyway—and strictly average voice acting. What you do get, however, is good, solid adrenaline-enriched dogfighting action in an aircraft of your choice, including the beautifully destructive F-22 Raptor.

Heatseeker proudly touts the Impact Cam, which follows your missile right to the aircraft it's headed for, showing you the fate of your victim in all its up-close and slow-motion glory. If you like watching big explosions unfold in slow motion, this should feed your appetite like your first meal after a day-long fast. Trouble is, while

you're watching the impact cam in glee, your aircraft switches to go-straight-without-thinking mode, meaning that you may well find your bird headed for the water when you get back. This can get annoying after a while, especially the fact that you enter impact cam when you hold down your fire key—taking you out of the action for those few precious moments.

Wherever else *Heatseeker* might fail, it doesn't disappoint in terms of action. You'll be met by barrages of enemy aircraft, and you get but a few seconds to breathe between waves. In-flight effects like afterburn are well-styled, and you'll be playing the *Top Gun* theme in your head in no time. Sink your money into this one for mindless entertainment, seen after a long time in a flight sim.

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Rating: 7/10
Developer: IR Gurus
Publisher: Codemasters
Distributor: E-Xpress Interactive

Contact: sales@e-xpressindia.com
Price: Rs 2,499
Platform: PS2